



Artificial intelligence - partner relationships management for climate management in B2B firms to achieve sustainable competitiveness

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ABSTRACT

Drawing on the dynamic capability view and resource-based view, this study investigates the relationship among artificial intelligence (AI)-based partner relationship management, firm performance, and sustainable competitiveness concerning the climate management of business-to-business (B2B) firms. Throughout this investigation, the study additionally explored the impact of several other dimensions, including information communication technology capability, firm fit, and technological readiness, as fundamental requirements for the implementation of AI-based partner relationship management. The present study also investigates the relationship between firm partner engagement and firm information processing systems for climate management of B2B firms and their impact on achieving firm performance and sustainable competitiveness. A mixed-methods approach was employed that involves in-depth interviews with senior managers from a diverse set of B2B firms, and the proposed hypothesis model was evaluated by analysing the collected B2B data of 142 responses using partial least squares structural equation modelling. The findings of the study show that information communication technology capability and technological readiness play a significant role in improving the performance of AI-based partner relationship management. Furthermore, the implementation of AI-based partner relationship management in B2B firms would help partner engagement and information processing systems for climate management, leading to sustainable firm competitiveness. The outcomes of this study offer many implications for managers and practitioners in the B2B sector and suggest potential avenues for future research.

1. Introduction

Firms are beginning to see the value of combating climate change, which is a major global concern. The United Nations Climate Change “Conference of the Parties” is an annual event where global leaders, policymakers, experts, and stakeholders come together to debate and negotiate solutions to climate change¹. The conference's goal is to facilitate international collaboration on climate change prevention and adaptation, and it serves as a stage for governments to present their progress in these areas.¹ As the effects of climate change become more widely understood, firms in all sectors have begun to put more emphasis

on environmentally responsible operations (Coppola & Blohmke, 2019). Firms that cater to other businesses have the potential to make an enormous difference by taking action on climate change. Taking measures to combat climate change has several potential benefits for business operations. First, it may aid in cost reduction by enhancing energy efficiency, reducing waste, and decreasing carbon emissions (Water, 2023). Additionally, it may improve a firm's image and give it an advantage in a crowded market, both of which are crucial for business-to-business (B2B) firms. Furthermore, combating climate change may inspire the creation of cutting-edge technologies and novel commercial offerings, generating additional sources of income. By placing a

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¹ <https://unfccc.int/climate-action/introduction-climate-action> (accessed on 19/04/2023)

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